



EVERPEACE COMPANIONSHIP
NOT-FOR-PROFIT CORPORATION · OTTAWA, ONTARIO, CANADA

Volunteer Code of Conduct

Appendix C · Adopted by the Board of Directors · Version 1.0 · August 2026

OUR MISSION

To reduce the loneliness and social isolation of Muslim seniors by building a structured network of volunteer companions who share their faith, language, and values, fostering meaningful relationships that promote dignity, spiritual well-being, and intergenerational connection.

Governance standard: Adopts the Canadian Code for Volunteer Involvement (CCVI) and establishes value-based, enforceable expectations.

WELCOME

Welcome to Everpeace Companionship. By joining our volunteer family, you are carrying forward a beautiful tradition of caring for our elders — a sacred duty in our faith and our community.

In alignment with the Canadian Code for Volunteer Involvement (CCVI), Everpeace Companionship is committed to providing a safe, supportive, and inclusive environment. In return, all volunteers are held to high standards of integrity, respect, and professionalism.

COMMITMENTS OF EVERY EVERPEACE VOLUNTEER

Everpeace Companionship relies on volunteers to enhance the programs, services, and experiences we provide to our seniors. Volunteers are expected to serve as role models and uphold the values of respect, integrity, and professionalism. This Code of Conduct outlines the expectations for all volunteers and helps ensure a safe, welcoming, and positive environment for seniors, members, staff, and fellow volunteers.

- 1. Respect and Dignity** — I will treat every senior with the utmost respect, patience, and kindness. I will never speak condescendingly, raise my voice, or act in any way that diminishes a senior's dignity.
-

2. Cultural Sensitivity, Respect, and Humility — I recognize that cultural humility is an active, ongoing commitment. I agree to approach my companionship visits with an open mind, self-reflection, and deep respect for the senior's autonomy. Specifically, I commit to the following:

2.1 Self-Reflection and Bias Mitigation. I will actively identify and set aside my own preconceived notions, personal beliefs, and potential biases before entering a senior's space. I will continuously address stereotypes to ensure interactions are respectful and constructive.

2.2 Recognition of Guest Status. I acknowledge that I am a guest in the senior's home or care facility. I will approach all interactions with curiosity and humility, recognizing that my role is to learn from and connect with our elders as much as it is to contribute support.

2.3 Avoidance of Generalizations. I will avoid snap judgments and cultural generalizations. I recognize that every individual senior's background, experience, and personal practice are unique.

2.4 Rejection of Paternalistic Narratives. I will consciously reject "hero" or "savior" narratives. I will not view myself as a rescuer or a superior actor, but rather as a partner in companionship. I will respect the strengths, lived experiences, wisdom, and autonomy of the seniors I visit.

2.5 Active Listening and Observation. I will prioritize objective listening and observation over offering "solutions" to perceived problems. I will allow team leads, coordinators, and the senior's primary care team to guide me regarding family and community dynamics.

2.6 Adherence to Community and Organizational Guidance. I acknowledge that my personal methods or perspectives are not universally applicable. I will remain flexible, adaptable, and let Everpeace Companionship and its partner facilities guide my involvement.

2.7 Respect for Personal and Cultural Boundaries. I will remain highly sensitive to boundaries regarding sensitive topics, personal traditions, sectarian differences, and spiritual practices. I will strictly follow the guidance of the Sector Coordinator regarding topics requiring additional sensitivity.

3. Punctuality and Reliability — I will honour my visit schedule. If I must cancel, I will notify my Sector Coordinator at least 24 hours in advance (except in genuine emergencies), acknowledging that unexpected cancellations cause distress to isolated seniors.

4. Professional Boundaries and Financial Integrity — I will maintain appropriate boundaries. I will not accept or request money, gift cards, credit/debit cards, valuables, or any other financial benefit from a senior or their family, even if offered voluntarily. I will not share my personal contact details for private visits outside the scope of the Everpeace Companionship program.

5. Confidentiality and Legislative Compliance — I will keep all personal and medical information about seniors, their families, and other volunteers strictly

confidential. I will share such information only with designated Everpeace staff in compliance with the Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPEDA) and Ontario's Personal Health Information Protection Act (PHIPA).

- 6. Safeguarding and Mandatory Reporting** — If I observe anything that suggests a senior is being harmed, neglected, financially exploited, or abused, I will immediately report it to my Sector Coordinator or the Executive Director.
- 7. Visit Protocol and Scope Limitations** — I will log every visit in the Everpeace Companionship Volunteer Portal within 24 hours. I will not conduct a visit alone in a private room without facility care staff or family members accessible in the vicinity.
- 8. Social Media and Photo Privacy** — I will respect the privacy of our seniors. I will not take photographs or record videos during visits, nor will I post any identifying information, photos, or comments about seniors, facilities, or Everpeace Companionship program participants on social media without express written authorization from Everpeace administration.
- 9. Representation and Ethical Character (Akhlāq)** — When I am at a care facility as an Everpeace volunteer, I represent our organization and our community. I will conduct myself with professionalism, humility, and exemplary Islamic character (akhlāq).
- 10. Mandatory Training and Self-Care Compliance** — I will complete all required orientation, training, and checking-in sessions before my first visit. I will actively monitor my own stress levels and follow the Volunteer Self-Care Guidelines to ensure I am physically and emotionally fit to provide companionship.

صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ

“He is not of us who does not show mercy to our young ones and respect to our elders.”

— The Prophet صلى الله عليه وسلم, Sunan al-Tirmidhī

VOLUNTEER ATTESTATION

By signing below, I attest that I have read, understood, and agree to uphold this Volunteer Code of Conduct. I understand that any violation may result in the immediate suspension or termination of my volunteer status.

VOLUNTEER FULL LEGAL NAME

SIGNATURE

DATE